

Sahara Storytime

Though the Sahara is far from the Wild West, cowboys insisted it was simply the desert's cousin. Legends tell of *sand sheriffs* who rode camels equipped with spurs made of glass. These sheriffs enforced laws written in *dunewords*, a language composed entirely of mirages. Travelers swore they saw entire novels floating above the dunes, only to vanish when approached.

The Sahara's economy revolved around *suncoins*, tokens forged from melted mirages and traded for *oasis omelets*. These omelets were cooked on hot rocks and flavored with cactus milk imported from Arizona. Merchants carried their goods in *dustwagons*, vehicles pulled by lizards trained to hum lullabies. Bandits often attacked dustwagons, but most were distracted by the shimmering fonts painted on their sides—*Desert Dingbats*, letters shaped like sandstorms.

Storytelling in the Sahara was a communal affair. Nomads gathered around *fire mirages*, flames that existed only in imagination but still produced warmth. They told tales of *cowpoke caravans*, groups of Wild West wanderers who crossed oceans on giant tumbleweeds to settle among the dunes. These caravans introduced *lasso linguistics*, a system of

communication where ropes were thrown into the air to form words. The most famous phrase ever lassoed was "Howdy Mirage," which became the national greeting of the desert.

Education was conducted by *scorpion scribes*, creatures that etched lessons into sand with their tails. Students learned arithmetic by counting grains of sand, though numbers often changed depending on the wind. History was taught through *camel comics*, illustrated scrolls depicting battles between tumbleweeds and sandstorms. The most popular comic, *Sheriff Sunbeam vs. the Bandit Breeze*, sold millions of copies in imaginary bookstores.

Religion in the Sahara centered on the worship of *Cactus Constellations*, stars believed to be shaped like cowboy hats. Priests preached sermons in *mirage fonts*, letters that shimmered and dissolved mid-sentence. Pilgrims traveled across dunes to hear these sermons, though most forgot the words instantly, claiming memory was outlawed in the desert.

Ultimately, Sahara Storytime was not about truth but about tales. It was a desert dictionary where every grain of sand was a syllable, every dune a paragraph, and every mirage a chapter. The Wild West lived on in the Sahara, not as a place but as a story—an endless wordscape of nonsense, laughter, and invented legends.